ECONOMIC CULTURES · MODULE 3

PROJECT BUDGET

What does your ambition cost?

a Situated Studio

a Situated Studio · Gemma Medina and Minsung Wang

THREE EVENINGS, SIX MODULES

EVENING	FIRST	AFTER THE BREAK
Tue 3 November	My hourly rate	From quote to invoice
Thu 5 November	Project budget	Seeds of Hope pt.1
Tue 10 November	Interdependence	Seeds of Hope pt.2

17.00 to 21.00, Room 2A. Each module takes about 90 minutes.

THE TOOLS AND MATERIALS, ALSO AFTERWARDS

bronvandoen.github.io/tags/economic-cultures

THANKS FOR BEING HERE

HOW WE WORK

This is a safe space to speak your mind; ask any question and make plenty of mistakes.

Respect each other’s time, effort and opinions.

Say hello to unfamiliar faces, we are here to learn from each other.

Please give us your full attention. We keep time quite strictly ☺

We take photos for documentation. Tell us if you’d rather not be in them.

WHY WE'RE HERE

BIG FISH, SMALL FISH

A quote fits your work into someone else's wish. A project budget starts from your ambition: what drives you to innovate.

A QUOTE · small fish

The client sets the wish and the money.

A PROJECT · BIG FISH

You set the ambition. Then you find who pays.

BEFORE WE START

A SOFT EXERCISE

We start with something light. On the way, we form the cell groups you work in for this module.

THE AMBITION SETS THE BUDGET

Not the fund. Pick a project of your own, from your graduation work or what came out of the show.

An exercise, not an application. Keep the plan short; name every part, person and payer.

A GRANT PAYS FOR A PURPOSE. BE BOLD ABOUT IT.

bronvandoen.github.io/tools/economic-cultures/ project-budget

MY PROJECT BUDGET · STEP 1 OF 9

THE AMBITION

What drives this project, and what does it make new? What can it become, with the time and money it needs?

PAUSE

Tell your cell your ambition, without apologising. Does it motivate you? Is it bold? Is the time honest?

THE PARTS

Which parts does your project have, and who does each one? Research, making, communication, documentation.

CHECK

A part with nobody in it is a gap. Who runs the emails, the money and the planning?

THE PEOPLE

YOUR OWN HOURS ARE A COST.

YOUR USUAL RATE

A floor, often kept low to win commissions.

A FUNDED RATE

The plan is judged, not your price. Each role gets fair pay.

€82.50

An hour at most, excl. VAT, at the Stimuleringsfonds.

In doubt about someone else's rate? Shout it out! What does a sound technician, a programmer or a producer cost? Ask the room.

YOUR COMMITMENT

Sam’s time in this project · 10 months, 2 days a week **693 h**



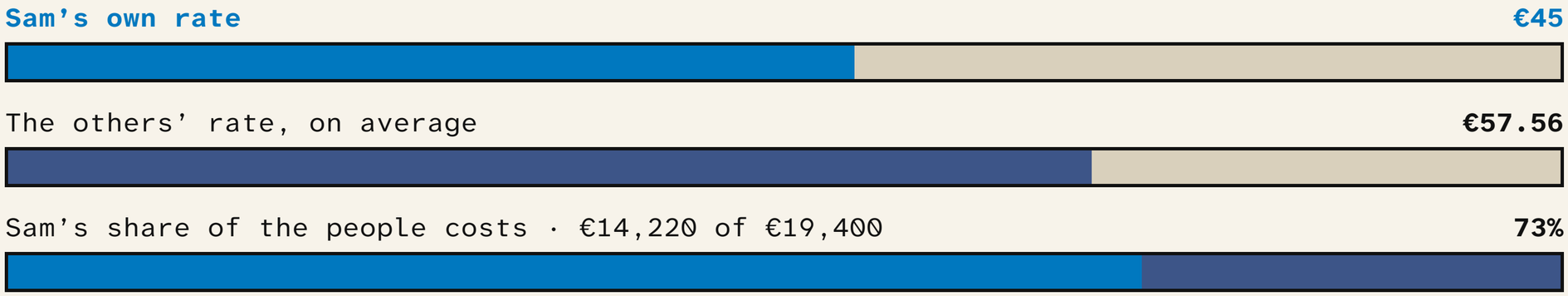
Sam’s hours in the budget · and 377 h given away, about €16,965 **316 h**



PAUSE

How big is the gap between the time you committed and the hours in your budget? How would you close it: budget your real hours, or adjust your commitment?

YOU AND THE OTHERS



Full bar: €82.50, the Stimuleringsfonds' cap for every role

PAUSE

Is the difference between your rate and theirs fair? If not, what would you change?

MATERIAL COSTS

Everything that isn’t somebody’s hours: location, materials, travel, transport, publicity, permits. Name each thing; no lumps.

WHAT MANY FUNDS WON’T PAY

A buffer for the unexpected, things that keep their value, and running your studio.

ASK AROUND

Prices you know beat prices you guess.

Shout it out! What do 300 printed books, a van for a weekend or a room for six sessions cost? Ask the room.

VAT

In your practice right now, do you charge VAT and file it every quarter?

YES

You get the VAT on your costs back. Your budget is without VAT.

NO: THE KOR, OR NOT REGISTERED

The VAT you pay is a real cost. Your budget includes it.

WHO COULD PAY

One fund rarely pays for everything. Who else wants this project to exist?

IN KIND
Free help, entered at its price

A PARTNER
Pays part, in money

A FUND
Or a municipality

SALES
Books, objects, tickets

AUDIENCE
Entry or workshop fees

SPONSORING
A company, for visibility

COFINANCING IS NOT A HURDLE
Other money means other people believe in it.

ALREADY ON PUBLIC MONEY
Schools and museums give a room, a lab or hours, not cash.

WHO PAYS FOR WHAT

Give every line someone who pays it. When “nobody yet” reaches zero, your budget is balanced.

LIKE A PUZZLE

Costs on one side, money on the other. A piece missing? Go back a step and change it.

“Me” pays for your hours? Then you work them for free. Choose it on purpose, or not at all.

CHECK AND TAKE IT WITH YOU

EVERY CHECK TICKED? CONGRATULATIONS, YOUR BUDGET IS COMPLETE!

Take a moment to enjoy it. Then save the PDF or the link: you will use it again in Module 4.

TO TAKE HOME

- What does a sustainable practice look like over three years instead of one project?
- Which of your unpaid hours are an investment, and which are a habit?
- Who else in your network could you budget for fairly?

MY PROJECT BUDGET · AFTER THE EXERCISE

YOUR NUMBER

HIGHER THAN YOU EXPECTED

Take courage. This is what your ambition costs, and why the grants exist.

LOWER THAN IT SHOULD BE

Be fairer to yourself. Who did you leave out, you included?

HOW DOES IT FEEL?

Is the money in the background, carrying you, so you can enjoy the work and invest in your craft? Or in the foreground, weighing on you?

MODULES 1, 2 AND 3 TOGETHER

THE CHAIN REACTION

	THE HOUR · M1		THE INVOICE · M2		THE BUDGET · M3
UNDERVALUED	A modest rate	→	Underpriced invoices, as a habit	→	A budget that can't carry your ambition
VALUED FAIRLY	A fair rate	→	Fair invoices; you learn to stand up for yourself	→	A healthy budget, priced with confidence

Does the Budget not feel right? Rewind. Look at how you invoice, then at how you value your hour.

What does your ambition cost?

YOUR AMBITION HAS A BUDGET, AND EVERY HOUR COUNTS, YOURS TOO.

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WE CONCLUDE THIS MODULE

GOOD WORK!

Let’s take a moment to reflect on what just happened.

Tell us what you felt and learned. A few lines are enough.

HOW WAS THIS MODULE?



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Thu 5 Nov · Project budget